AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

EA300B
Children's Literature (II)
All Branches
FINAL EXAM (MAIN)

2024-2025 / First Semester
Date: 5 Jan. 2025
9:30 – 12:30

ımber of Exam Pages: 3 luding this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 3 hours**

ISTRUCTIONS

There are THREE sections in this exam paper:

1. You are required to answer TWO questions from Section 1. ONE question from Sectio 2. Section 3 is MANDATORY.
2. Answers in Section 1 should be in the form of short answers.
3. Answers in section 2 & 3 should be in standard essay format: Start with a thesis, end with conclusion, define all important terms, and provide specific and appropriate examples. Analyz and discuss the examples.
4. Edit your answers, paying attention to grammar, punctuation, and spelling.
5. Cross out any notes you make which you do not want to be considered.
6. It is also necessary to refer to relevant critical essays to support your analysis.

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SECTION 1: SHORT ANSWERS (10 marks)

Answer TWO of the following three questions in 50 words each.

1. **"In Beatrix Potter's *The Tale of Peter Rabbit*, the natural setting influences and reflects Peter's journey throughout the tale." Comment. (5 marks)**

2. **"The ending of *The Tale of Peter Rabbit* suggests a lack of punitive spirit in the mother Rabbit, as she responds to Peter's mischief with gentle care rather than harsh punishment." Comment. (5 marks)**

3. **In A. Browne's *Voices in the Park*, the use of colours, seasons, and fonts serves as symbolic codes throughout the picture book. Identify and comment on these codes, and on how they contribute to the overall meaning of the story. (5 marks)**

SECTION 2: ESSAY WRITING

Answer EITHER Question 1 OR Question 2 250 WORDS (20 MARKS)

Question 1: In P. Pearce's *Tom's Midnight Garden*, Tom and Hatty's connection defies typical notions of age and time through their shared experiences in the garden. Discuss with reference to specific episodes from the novel.

OR

Question 2: Philippa Pearce claims that *Tom's Midnight Garden* is a realistic novel. Do yo agree? Evaluate Pearce's peculiar combination of realistic and fantastic elements. Can th novel still be considered realistic despite this hybridity?

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SECTION 3: CLOSE READING **(Mandatory)** **250 WORDS** **(20 marks)**

Analyze the passage from B. Naidoo's *The Other Side of Truth*, focusing on Sade's reflection on her father's teachings about bullies, and how they impact her changing perspective on bravery and resistance.

Why was she letting Marcia sneak inside her head and frighten her so much? She hardly knew her and yet here was the girl already in her dreams, mixed up in her nightmare about Mama. If she could talk with Papa, she could imagine what he would say. At least what he would have said before Mama died.

We have to stand up to bullies, Sade girl! Otherwise, they get inside your head. That's how they succeed in controlling us. The Bully-Boy Soldiers rule us today because most people let them. They frighten us into believing they are all-powerful. Without their brass buttons they are nothing.

Everything Papa said was true. But what happens when you stand up alone yet everyone else is too frightened? That's what she wanted to ask him. What would he say now … after what they did to Mama? And what if some people actually blamed Papa? They might say, look, it was your fault.

If you had kept quiet, like everyone else, your wife wouldn't have been killed. Your children wouldn't have lost their mother.

Sade's mind suddenly jumped to Uncle Tunde's face as he accused Papa.

'You call your article "Our Children's Future". What do you imagine will happen now to your own, Folarin?'

Then the next moment her uncle and father were agreeing that Uncle Dele would look after the children in London. But would they have still sent them in the aeroplane with that awful Peacock Lady if they had known Uncle Dele had gone missing? Where on earth was he? Sade tossed and turned. Too many awful questions were scurrying into her brain. As if she had trodden on a nest of giant ants and they were crazily trying to reassemble themselves.

***The Other Side of Truth* (2000) p. 10**

End of Exam

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